The Dhāraṇī of Powerful Speech is a brief ritual incantation that opens with hom

Toh 1027 · Derge Kangyur

The Dhāraṇī of Powerful Speech is a brief ritual incantation that opens with homage to the Three Jewels and a short mantra invoking the Blessed One as the uṣṇīṣa, the crown protuberance of a buddha. Its Sanskrit and Tibetan titles cannot be determined with confidence from the surviving title lines. The text promises that its formula works even without prior practice. It then sets out a series of simple practical rites. Reciting it over bezoar and marking the forehead, or over eye ointment applied to the eyes, makes others well disposed toward the practitioner. Reciting it over a handful of water and drinking it brings food without begging. Reciting it while holding the hem of one's garment before entering an assembly makes one's words prevail over all others. It is Toh 1027 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the many short dhāraṇī texts that offer protective and worldly benefits through the recitation of sacred formulas.

Homage to the Three Jewels!

namo bhagavate uṣṇīṣāya dhare rante svāhā

Even without prior practice, all actions will be accomplished.

If one recites it one hundred and eight times over bezoar (gorocanā) and makes a mark on one's forehead, whoever one looks at will be pleased.

If one incants it one hundred and eight times over eye ointment and applies it to the eyes, whoever one is to meet will be pleased.

If one recites it seven times over a handful of water and drinks it, one will obtain food without having to beg.

When going into an assembly, one should hold the hem of one's own garment with the left hand and recite it twenty-one times. Then within the assembly one's words will prevail above all others.

The dhāraṇī of powerful speech is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The text reads "into the sickness of the assembly," which makes no sense here. I have translated it as "into an assembly," taking the word as an evident slip for the similar-looking word for "into." The phrase "even without prior practice" renders "even without accomplishing." It most likely means that the dhāraṇī works without a preliminary recitation retreat, but it could

also be read as "even without effort."

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.